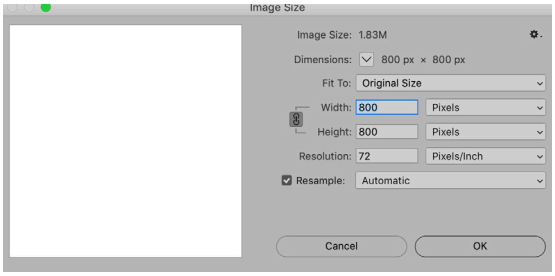
Photos Selections in Adobe Photoshop

One of the benefits of Adobe Photoshop is the ability to select and bring photographic elements from other images into your file to make complex compositions. In today's lab we build a space scene composition that combines elements from different images and works with the concept of Photoshop Layers.

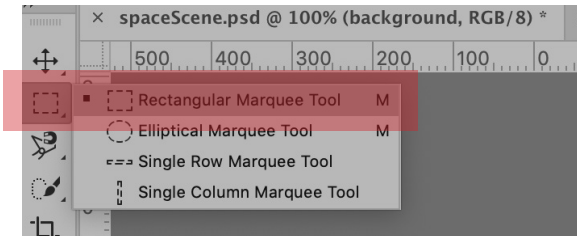
Setup

Begin by opening up *SpaceScene.psd* into Adobe Photoshop. Currently the scene is empty, but if you go to *Image > Image Size* you can see that the size of the canvas is 800px 800px.

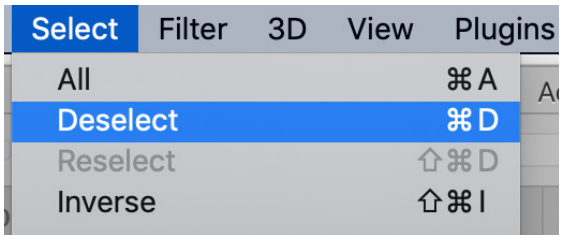


Add a Background

Let's begin by adding a cool background image to our scene. Open the image *spaceBackground.jpg* into Adobe Photoshop. This image will be the background to our composition.



In order to get the space background image information into our composition we need to copy it. In order for Adobe Photoshop to know which part of the image to copy we must select it first or make a selection.

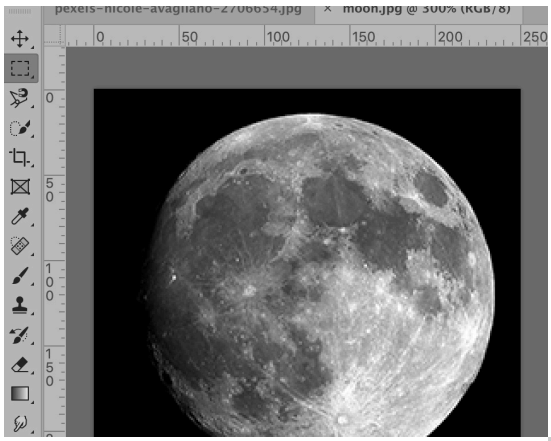


Let's begin by making a basic rectangular marquee selection. In the *Tools* select *Rectangular Marquee*. Then click and drag over the entire space image. If you make a mistake you can always remove your selection by going to *Select > Deselect* or using *Command / CTRL + D.*

Now that we've made the selection, let's copy the information into our main composition. To do this go to *Edit > Copy* menu or use *Command / CTRL + C*. Now go back to our *SpaceScene.psd* and paste the image by going to *Edit > Paste* or *Command / CTRL + V.*

Your composition will look roughly like the image on the right.

Add a Moon

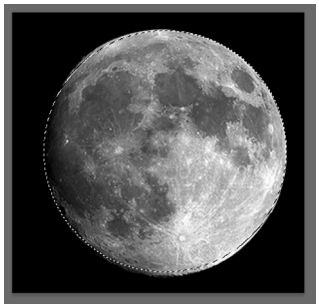


Let's add more to our compositon, let's add a moon! Open *moon.jpg* into Adobe Photoshop. Since the moon is circular the rectangular marquee tool may not be the best tool for the job her; instead, let's switch to a different marquee tool, the ***elipitical marquee*** tool. You can switch to elipitcal marquee tool by holding down your mouse on the rectangular marquee tool until the popup menu appears.

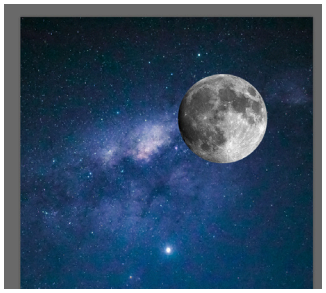
Click and drag with the elliptical marquee tool and you'll see that

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you create a circular selection instead of a rectangular one. To help with selecting the moon it may help to start from the center, rather than the upper left hand corner. To do this hold the ***option / alt*** key when you first use the tool to start from the center of the moon.

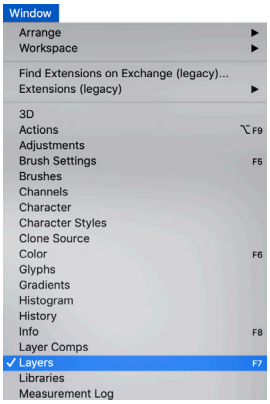


Copy and paste the moon into *SpaceScene.psd*, it should look somewhat similar to the image on the right.

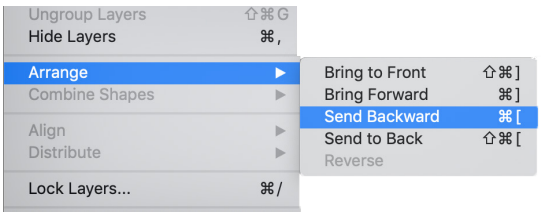


Layers

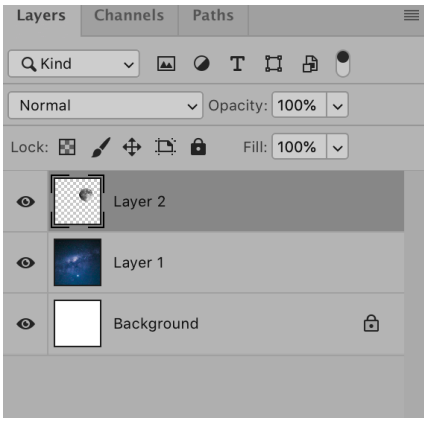
Part of makes Adobe Photoshop such a sophisticated photo editing program is the ability to separate content into different sections. The separation allows us to edit part of our composition without affecting other parts of the composition. Adobe Photoshop does this with what is called ***layers***. ***Layers*** separate content into different sections that we can edit and modify at our pace.



To see the layers for our composition go to *Window > Layers* or press F7. You should see something that looks roughly like the image on the right. All the layers combine on top of one another known as a layer stack. The layer on top of the stack is closer to the camera than the layers below it. The layer on the bottom is called the ***base layer*** and the layer on top is called the dominant layer as nothing blocks it. In my example the moon layer is dominant layer above the space background. To change order of the layer the user can click and drag a layer up or down the layer stack or go to *Layer > Arrange > Bring Forward* or *Layer > Arrange > Bring Backwards*. The keyboard shortcut is ***command / CTRL + [or command / CTRL +]***



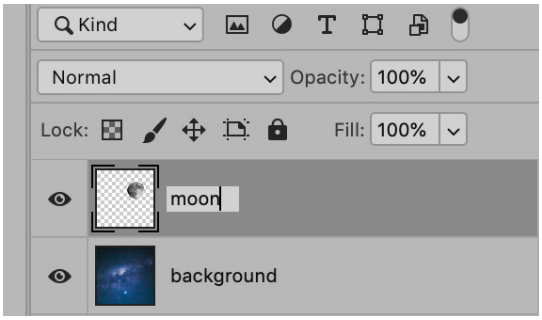
You can see that the space background and moon are separate from one another in different layers. If you select the layer that contains the space background image and use the move tool, it will move the background but not the moon. If you click on the layer containing the moon the same would happen, but in reverse.



When you copy image information into a Photoshop document it defaultly will create a new layer with that information.

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Layer Organization

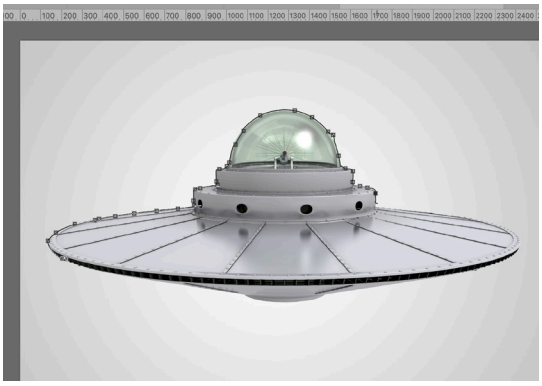


Just as it is helpful to organize files on your computer with proper naming it is helpful to organize the layers in Adobe Photoshop such as giving our layers names. To give a layer a name double click on the layer current name, type a new name and then hit *enter / return* to save the layer name.

Give each layer in the *spaceScene.psd* a proper name.

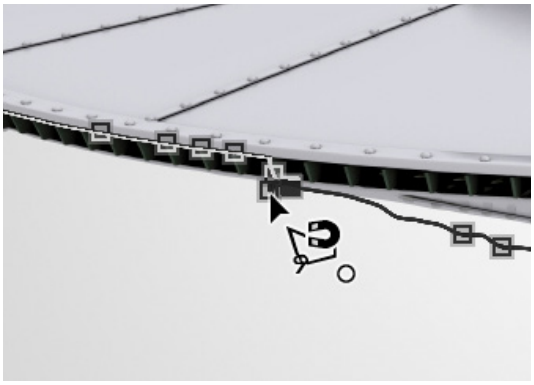
More Selection Tools

Let's add a few more elements to our scene. Open *spaceship.jpg* into Adobe Photoshop. Due to the spaceship being very curvy and bulbus a rectangular or ellptical marquee tool will not work here. Instead, let's use a tool that allows us to make our own selections.



Click and hold on the *lasso* tool in the tool box until the submenu appear. Choose the *magnetic lasso* tool. The magnetic lasso tool is a tool that is good for selecting organic objects or objects that do not have angular or perfectly straight lines. The magnetic lasso tool can snap to the contrast between the foreground and the background of an image, so this is good with images that have strong contrast between the figure we want and the background.

In *spaceship.jpg* click on the edge where the spaceship meets the background. The proceed to drag your cursor around the object, as you drag you'll see the selection line. You'll see small boxes, or anchors in your selection. These anchors dictate the selection of the image.



It is a good idea to go slow to get the best results. You may want to zoom in and out using the keyboard shortcuts *command / CTRL + "+ / -"* to assist with selecting. You may also want to pan around your scene by using the *spacebar*. If you make a mistake you can use the *delete* or *backspace* to undo previous anchors in your selection.

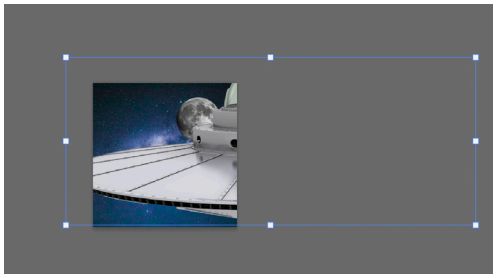
Once you've gone around the entire spaceship and returned to the starting point you should see an icon that looks like the one on the right that shows a small circle. This circle means you are making a complete selection. If you have trouble getting this you can hit the '*enter / return*' key to close your selection as well.

Create a selection of the spaceship. After you select the spaceship copy it and paste into *spaceScene.psd*. Rename the layer to '*spaceship*'.

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Resize a Layer

When you copy and paste images into compositions they do not always match the dimensions of the current scene. In this case the spaceship is too large for our scene and is currently getting cropped on the sides. To fix this issue let's resize the spaceship layer by using the *Free Transform* tool. Go to *File > Free Transform* or use *Command / CTRL + T*.



You'll get a tranform bounding box, you can use the small squares at the edges to readjust the size of the spaceship. Scale the spaceship down so it fits nicely inside our scene. When you are done adjusting the size hit the return or enter key.

Duplicate and Rotate

Sometimes we may want to duplicate an entire layer in our composition; reasons for doing this include having a copy of our work, or just wanting an additional version of the content for our composition. It would be cool to have spaceships go off into the distance towards the moon for our compositon.



Select the *Spaceship* Layer and go to *Layer > Duplicate Layer* or use *Command / CTRL + J*. This will duplicate your spaceship into a new layer. Rename the new layer *spaceship2*. Move the spaceship below the first spaceship layer so the original is in front. Use *Free Transform* to scale the duplicate layer a bit smaller.

Let's have the duplicate layer look a bit different than the original layer so let's rotate it. To rotate a layer we also use the Free Transform tool. Press *Command / CTRL + T* and place your cursor just beyond the corners, you'll see double ended arrows appear, similar to the image on the right. This will allow you to rotate your layer. Rotate your layer a bit.



Finally duplicate the *spaceship2* layer and name it *spaceship3*. Use the Free Transform tool to scale it and rotate it smaller than the first two. Set the layers so the spaceships appear to be coming from the moon.

Add an Alien



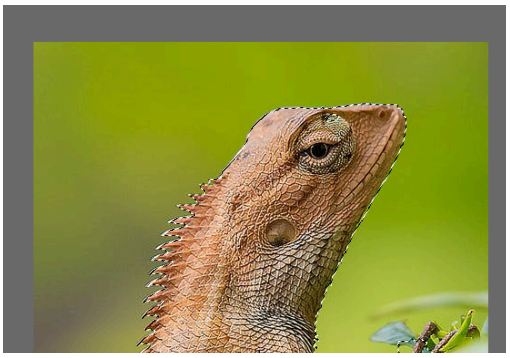
Let's put the finishing touches on our scene by adding in an alien! Begin by loading *lizard.jpg* into Adobe Photoshop. Since the lizard is an organic object is would be difficult to use a marquee tool. One thing to notice is that the lizard colors of orange and brown are dramatically different from the background green. What we can use is the *Quick Selection tool*. The *Quick Selection* is a brush based tool that allows us to select pixels of a similar color range,

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like those in the lizard. You can find the Quick Selection tool in the subtools of the *Object Selection*.

Use the tool and click on the lizard and you'll see it makes a selection. Drag the cursor and you'll see that Adobe Photoshop begins to snap to the other colors in the lizard.

Select the entire lizard and copy and paste it into your composition, label the layer ***alien***. Feel free to use the move tool and *Free Transform* to readjust the layer.





Submission

Violá, you created an interesting space scene by combining different photographic elements together.

Make sure your file is saved as a PSD file. Submit the ***spaceScene.psd*** file to Canvas as your *lastname-firstname-spaceScene.psd*. You only need to submit the main file, not the raw image files used to create the document.

Extra Credit (+1 Extra Points Not Required)

Add at least two additional space related elements to the scene. They could be stars, comets, space stations or anything else that fits the composition.

Use the move / Free-Transform to place the items in the compositon.

Make sure your selections are crisp and good.

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